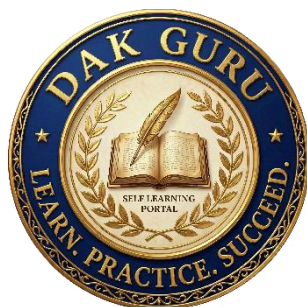




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CITIZENS' CHARTER

of the

DEPARTMENT OF POSTS

A declaration of the Department's service commitment to its customers

ABOUT THIS EDITION

Detailed & Exam-Ready Study Notes

Base document: the official Citizens' Charter revised in **June 2021** (the latest version published by the Department).

Currency verified and updated: **August 2026**

- *Contact and grievance channels refreshed.*

LEARN. PRACTICE. SUCCEED.

Disclaimer

This booklet is an educational compilation prepared by **Dak Guru** (www.dakguru.com) to help aspirants of the Limited Departmental Competitive Examinations for Inspector Posts (IP) and Postal Services (PS) Group 'B', and departmental staff, study the *Citizens' Charter of the Department of Posts* in a clear and structured form.

- The authoritative text is the **official Citizens' Charter of the Department of Posts (revised June 2021)** published at www.indiapost.gov.in. Where this booklet adds explanation, context or updates, that material is clearly marked and is for study convenience only.
- Service standards, contact details, portals and monetary/legal provisions **change from time to time**. Every currency-sensitive item here was verified against primary/official sources in **August 2026**; readers must re-confirm against the latest orders, circulars and the current charter before relying on any point for official or examination purposes.
- Two transcription errors present in the uploaded source file have been corrected to match the official charter. These are listed transparently in **Part 9 – Currency & Verification Record**.
- Dak Guru is an independent self-learning platform and is **not an official publication of the Department of Posts or the Government of India**. No official endorsement is claimed or implied.
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HOW TO READ THE COLOURED BOXES IN THIS BOOKLET

In Plain Terms — a simple explanation of the rule in everyday language.

Exam Focus — the specific point most likely to be tested.

Currency Alert — where the 2021 charter has been overtaken by a later position, or where a source error was corrected.

Memory Hook / Departmental Angle — an aid to recall, or how the point plays out in day-to-day office work.

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Part 1 — Understanding the Citizens' Charter

1.1 What is a Citizens' Charter?

A Citizens' Charter is a written, public **declaration by a public organisation of the standard of service** a citizen can expect from it, the timelines within which each service will be delivered, and the way to seek redress if those promises are not met. It is not a law and does not create legally enforceable rights by itself; it is a *commitment* that makes the organisation accountable and the citizen better informed.

IN PLAIN TERMS

Think of the Charter as the Department of Posts publicly saying: "Here is exactly what we do, how many days each job will take, what we expect from you, and where to complain if we fall short." Once it is printed, staff can be held to it and customers know what is reasonable to expect.

1.2 Where the Charter comes from — the Sevottam idea

The Citizens' Charter movement in India began in **1997**, when the Conference of Chief Ministers adopted an '*Action Plan for Effective and Responsive Government*'. The initiative is coordinated by the **Department of Administrative Reforms & Public Grievances (DARPG)**. Every charter is expected to sit within the **Sevottam** framework, which has three pillars: (i) a Citizens' Charter, (ii) a Public Grievance Redress system, and (iii) service-delivery capability. This is why the DoP charter always carries both a *service-standards* section and a *grievance-redress* section.

EXAM FOCUS

Remember the **three pillars of Sevottam** — Charter + Grievance Redress + Service Delivery capability — and that **DARPG** is the nodal department. The Citizens' Charter concept in India dates to **1997**.

1.3 The standard building blocks of a charter

A model Citizens' Charter has six recognisable components. The DoP charter follows this pattern:

- **Vision and Mission** — what the organisation aspires to be and its core purpose.
- **List of services and customers/clients** — who is served and with what.
- **Service standards** — measurable time-limits for each transaction (the heart of the charter).
- **Expectations from citizens** — the customer's responsibilities that let the standards be met.

- **Grievance-redress mechanism** — how, where and within how many days a complaint is settled.
- **Review clause** — a stated date by which the charter will be revised.

1.4 Which version is this, and is it current?

This booklet is built on the **Citizens' Charter of the Department of Posts revised in June 2021**, published on www.indiapost.gov.in. That document itself states that its **next review was due in July 2022**. As verified in August 2026, **no later charter has been published by the Department** — so the June 2021 charter remains the latest official version, even though it is overdue for review. The substance below is therefore presented faithfully, with every point that has since been overtaken by a fresh order flagged as a **Currency Alert**.

CURRENCY ALERT

Legal backdrop has changed since 2021. The *Indian Post Office Act, 1898* has been replaced by the **Post Office Act, 2023 (Act 43 of 2023)**, in force from **18 June 2024**, and the **Post Office Rules, 2024** came into force on **16 December 2024**. The charter's service commitments continue to operate, but the underlying statute is now the 2023 Act. Separately, a customer's right against '*deficiency in service*' is backed by the **Consumer Protection Act, 2019**.



Part 2 — Vision, Mission and Customers

2.1 Our Vision

"India Post's products and services will be the customer's first choice."

In plain terms: whenever a citizen needs to send something, save money, insure a life or remit funds, India Post wants to be the **first option that comes to mind** — not the last resort.

2.2 Mission

The mission has four commitments:

1. To sustain its position as the **largest postal network in the world**, touching the lives of every citizen in the country.
2. Ensuring **customer satisfaction** by providing services with **speed, reliability and on a value-for-money basis**.
3. To ensure that employees serve their customers **with a human touch**.
4. To continue to deliver **social security services** and to enable **last-mile connectivity** as a Government of India platform.

MEMORY HOOK

Four mission words: **Largest – Satisfaction – Human touch – Social security/Last-mile**. ("Big network, happy customer, warm service, reaches everyone.")

2.3 Our Customers / Clients

- All individuals and corporate customers.
- Public institutions, private businesses and media.
- Government organisations.
- Other postal administrations (i.e., foreign posts, for international mail exchange).

Part 3 — Our Services

The charter groups India Post's offerings into four families of service.

3.1 Mail Services

- Letters, postcards, inland letter cards, book packets, Value Payable Post (VPP), parcels, Logistics Post, ePost, etc.
- Registration and insurance of postal articles and parcels covered by that facility.
- **Premium mail services** — Speed Post, Business Post, Business Parcel, Direct Post, Bill Mail Service, Logistics Post, etc.
- Delivery is carried out by the designated delivery post offices and Branch Offices.

3.2 Financial Services

- **Money transfer** — Money Order, Indian Postal Order (IPO), etc.
- **Post Office Savings Bank (POSB)** — Small Savings Schemes and Savings Certificates.
- **Postal Life Insurance (PLI) and Rural Postal Life Insurance (RPLI).**

3.3 Philately

- Promotion of philately.
- Issue of definitive postage stamps.
- Issue of commemorative and special postage stamps.
- Delivery through Philatelic Bureaux and counters, as well as through the ePost Office (www.epostoffice.gov.in).

3.4 Counter Services

Counter services are provided from post offices (Departmental and Branch Offices), Mail Offices, or any other outlet designated for the purpose. They include:

- Sale of postage stamps and postal stationery, etc.
- Booking of registered, insured, Speed Post and other mail articles.
- Booking of money orders and various POSB and PLI/RPLI transactions.
- **ePost Office** — anytime, anywhere transactions for electronic money order, PLI premium and philately products.

DEPARTMENTAL ANGLE — SERVICES BEYOND THE 2021 CHARTER

The charter lists the *core* postal, financial, insurance and philately services. In day-to-day counters you will also handle several **newer service lines that the 2021 charter does not separately cover**: India Post Payments Bank (IPPB) and Aadhaar-enabled payments, Post Office Passport Seva Kendras (POPSK), Aadhaar enrolment/updation

at select offices, Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT), and recent initiatives such as **DIGIPIN** (the digital postal address grid) and the **DakGhar Niryat Kendra (DNK)** export facility. These carry their own operating instructions and are noted here only for completeness — they are not part of the charter's service-standard tables.



Part 4 — Service Standards: A. Mails & Money Order

4.1 Three rules that govern every mail standard

Before reading any delivery table, note the three qualifying conditions the charter attaches to all mail/MO standards:

1. Time is counted **excluding**: the day of posting for articles booked after the cut-off time, holidays and Sundays; and any adverse effect beyond the Department's control (curfew, bandh, strike, cancellation of transport, off-loading/non-carriage by carriers, and force majeure).
2. An article or Money Order **booked or delivered at a Branch Office takes 1 extra day**.
3. Standards apply only to articles conforming to **Gazette Notification No. 486 dated 23.09.2013** (excluding Money Order) and bearing the **correct address and PIN code**.

EXAM FOCUS

Two favourite one-liners: (a) **BO booking/delivery = +1 day**; (b) mail standards are tied to **Gazette Notification No. 486 dated 23.09.2013** and a correct address + PIN. Sundays, holidays and the day of posting (after cut-off) are **not counted**.

4.2 What 'Local' and 'Metro' mean

"Local" means:

- For Metro cities — articles booked and to be delivered within the identified PIN codes.
- For cities other than Metro cities — within the Municipality limit.
- For small towns (kasbas) or mofussil areas with no defined town-delivery area — within the same PIN-code delivery jurisdiction.

"Metro" means the municipal limits of **Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad and Bengaluru** (six cities).

MEMORY HOOK

Six postal metros: **Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru** — the same six used for the Money Order 'metro' standard.

4.3 Delivery of First-Class Mail & Registered Letters

First-Class Mail = Letters, Postcards and Letter cards (and Registered Letters). Time from posting to delivery:

From → To	Service Standard
Local *	2 days
Metro – Metro **	2 – 4 days
Same State	2 – 6 days

From → To	Service Standard
State Capital → State Capital	3 – 5 days
Rest of the country	5 – 6 days

CURRENCY ALERT – SOURCE ERROR CORRECTED

The uploaded booklet had the “Same State” and “State Capital → State Capital” values swapped. The official charter assigns 2–6 days to Same State and 3–5 days to State-Capital-to-State-Capital. The table above uses the correct official values.

4.4 Delivery of Speed Post articles

From → To	Service Standard
Local *	1 – 2 days
Metro – Metro	1 – 3 days
State Capital → State Capital	1 – 4 days
Same State	1 – 4 days
Rest of the country	4 – 5 days

4.5 Delivery of Business Parcel & Second-Class Mail

Second-Class Mail = Parcel, Book packet, Registered Newspapers and Blind-Literature packets.

From → To	Service Standard
Local *	3 days
Metro – Metro **	4 – 5 days
State Capital → State Capital	4 – 6 days
Same State	3 – 6 days
Rest of the country	6 – 7 days

4.6 International EMS articles (key countries)

All international mail is subject to customs examination; the period of customs examination/detention is **not included** in the standard. These are “**end-to-end**” standards for outbound articles booked in cities that have Office of Exchange (OE) — namely **Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai and Kochi**. For articles booked elsewhere, the domestic Speed Post timeline is added. A frequently-tested selection:

Country	Days	Country	Days
Australia	4 – 8	Russia	5 – 9
Canada	5 – 9	Saudi Arabia	4 – 8
China	4 – 9	Singapore	3 – 6
France	4 – 8	South Korea	3 – 7

Country	Days	Country	Days
Japan	3 – 6	Taiwan	3 – 6
Malaysia	3 – 7	UAE	4 – 8
United Kingdom	2 – 6	USA	4 – 7

CURRENCY ALERT – SOURCE ERROR CORRECTED

The uploaded booklet's summary list had **France and Japan swapped** (France 3–6, Japan 4–8). The correct values — matching both the official charter and the full country annexure — are **France 4–8 and Japan 3–6**. The full 106-country list is at **Annexure I**.

4.7 Money remittance

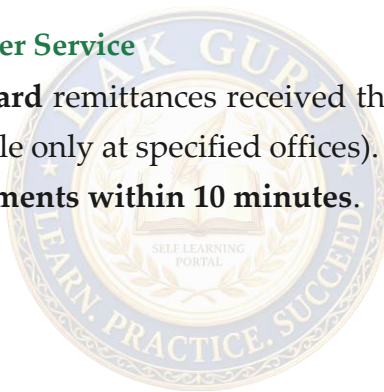
2.1 Delivery of Money Order

Qualifying Description	Service Standard
Local * and between Metro cities **	2 working days
Rest of India	4 working days

* Local = within Municipal City limits. ** Metro = Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru.

2.2 International Money Transfer Service

This is payment of instant **inward** remittances received through money-transfer operators such as Western Union (available only at specified offices). Payment is made **on production of the code and required documents within 10 minutes**.



Part 5 — Service Standards: B. Post Office Savings Bank

The charter gives POSB standards in two blocks — one for non-CBS offices and one for CBS offices. Read the Currency Alert first.

CURRENCY ALERT — READ THIS BEFORE THE TABLES

The Department has migrated all departmental post offices to the **Core Banking Solution (CBS / Finacle)**. In practice, block 3(b) — CBS is now the **operative** set of standards for departmental offices, and Branch Offices work on Darpan hand-held devices linked to their account office's CBS. Block 3(a) — **non-CBS** is retained here for completeness because it still appears in the official charter, but it is effectively **legacy**.

5.1 Block 3(a) — POSB standards for non-CBS offices (legacy)

3.1 Transfer of accounts (collect a dated receipt)

Qualifying Description	Standard
Within the same Head Post Office	1 working day
From one Head Post Office to another	7 working days
Requested at the transferee post office	15 days

3.2 Settlement of customer requests

Request	Standard
Deceased claim — where nomination exists	1 working day
Deceased claim — where no nomination exists	7 working days
Issue of duplicate passbook	7 working days
Interest posting	1 working day

(Deceased-claim standards run *after receipt of complete documents*.)

3.3 – 3.5 Savings Certificates (non-CBS)

Request	Standard
Discharge at a post office other than the office of purchase	30 working days
Transfer of a Savings Certificate	30 working days
Duplicate certificate — issued before 01.07.2016	15 working days
Duplicate certificate — issued on/after 01.07.2016 (at HO)	1 day
Duplicate certificate — issued on/after 01.07.2016 (at SO)	7 days

IN PLAIN TERMS — WHY 01.07.2016 MATTERS

From **1 July 2016**, National Savings Certificates (NSC) and Kisan Vikas Patra (KVP) stopped being issued as *printed paper certificates* and moved to **passbook / e-mode**. That is why duplicates for older *paper* certificates take longer (15 days) than for newer passbook-mode holdings (1 day at HO / 7 days at SO).

5.2 Block 3(b) – POSB standards for CBS offices (operative)

No.	Transaction / Request	Standard
3.1.1	Transfer of accounts — at any Head Post Office	1 working day
3.1.1	Transfer of accounts — at any Sub Post Office	3 working days
3.1.2	Deceased claim with nomination — at HO or SO	1 working day
3.1.3	Deceased claim without nomination — within powers of HO/SO	1 working day
3.1.3	Deceased claim without nomination — beyond HO/SO, within Divisional Head's powers	7 working days
3.1.4	Duplicate passbook — at HO	1 working day
3.1.4	Duplicate passbook — at any SO (movement to HO and back)	7 working days
3.1.5	Interest posting	1 working day (same day)
3.1.6	Discharge of certificates at another PO after transfer — at HO	1 working day
3.1.6	Discharge — at SO (cash / transfer to savings account)	1 working day
3.1.6	Discharge — at SO (by cheque)	3 working days
3.1.7	Transfer of certificates — at HO	1 working day
3.1.7	Transfer of certificates — at SO	3 working days
3.1.7	Transfer — physical certificate issued before 01.07.2016, at any SO	3 working days
3.1.8	Duplicate certificate — issued before 01.07.2016	15 working days
3.1.8	Duplicate certificate — issued on/after 01.07.2016 (HO / SO)	1 day / 7 days
3.1.9	Opening of account / purchase of certificates (after cheque clearance)	1 working day
3.1.10	Closure of account — at HO	1 working day
3.1.10	Closure — at SO (cash / transfer to savings account)	1 working day
3.1.10	Closure — at SO (by cheque)	3 working days
3.1.11	Issue of ATM card — Insta (instant)	1 working day
3.1.12	Issue of ATM card — Personalized	30 days
3.1.13	Enabling e-banking / m-banking	1 working day

EXAM FOCUS

High-frequency numbers: **Personalized ATM card = 30 days; Insta ATM card / e-banking / interest posting = 1 working day; SO transactions needing physical movement or cheque clearance = 3 working days; deceased claim beyond HO/SO powers = 7 working days.**

Part 6 — Service Standards: C. PLI/RPLI, Counters, BO, AO & Grievances

6.1 Postal Life Insurance & Rural Postal Life Insurance

All standards run from receipt of completed documents / request.

No.	Service	Standard
4.1	Issue of acceptance letter / issue of policy bond	15 days
4.2	Maturity claim / paid-up value / survival benefit payment	15 days
4.3	PLI/RPLI death claim — with or without nomination	30 days
4.3	PLI/RPLI death claim — involving investigation	90 days
4.4	Revival of policy / conversion of policy	15 days
4.5(i)	Loan against policy	10 days
4.5(ii)	Change of address	5 days
4.5(iii)	Change of nomination	10 days
4.5(iv)	Assignment of policy	10 days
4.5(v)	Issue of duplicate policy bond	10 days

MEMORY HOOK

PLI made simple: **most jobs = 15 days; death claim = 30 days (90 if investigation); change of address = the only 5-day item**; the rest of the small requests (loan, nomination, assignment, duplicate bond) = **10 days**.

6.2 Counter Services

Service	Standard
Counter services (excluding waiting time in queue)	2 – 5 minutes
5.1 Sale of philatelic stamps and items	Same day

6.3 Branch Office transaction time

Transaction authorised at the Branch Office	Time
Sale of stamps & stationery; miscellaneous services	3 minutes
Booking of Registered Articles / Money Orders; collection & payment of PLI premia; POSB deposit & withdrawal	10 minutes

6.4 Transactions routed through the Account Office

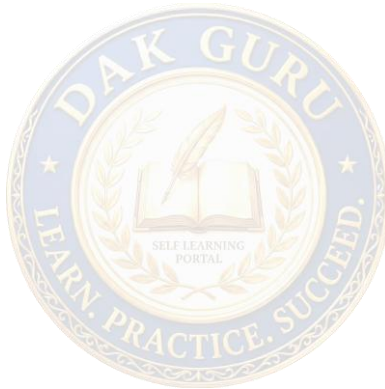
Transactions of **all nine schemes** that must be authorised/routed through the Account Office take **6 days in addition** to the relevant standard declared for authorised Branch Offices.

IN PLAIN TERMS

A Branch Office cannot finally authorise certain scheme transactions on its own — the paperwork travels to its Account Office (the linked Sub/Head Office) and back. The charter builds in **+6 days** for that movement on top of the ordinary BO standard.

6.5 Public Grievance Redress — service standards

No.	Item	Standard
8.1	Issue of acknowledgement of complaint	Same day (instantaneous for web registration)
8.2	Settlement of complaints	60 days
8.3	Settlement of complaints requiring investigation	90 days



Part 7 — Miscellaneous

7.1 Reasonable expectations from service recipients (D.1)

The charter is a two-way promise: standards are guaranteed only if customers do their part.

Mails

- Address of both addressee and sender should carry House Number, Street name, City, District, State and PIN Code; for rural addresses, the village name and the delivery Branch Office; phone numbers of sender and addressee (optional).
- Follow the packaging tips and prohibited-articles list published on www.indiapost.gov.in (MBE pages).
- Affix the correct amount of postage.
- Provide a mail box on the ground floor for each address in a multi-storeyed building.
- Notify the delivery post office of any change of address and give a forwarding address.
- Give proper authorisation to a representative for receiving delivery of registered, insured, money-order and Speed Post articles in your absence.

Money Order / Mail services

- Cooperate by producing ID on demand by the Postman or at the counter.
- Insist on obtaining receipts for articles and money orders booked.

Savings Bank / Certificates / Insurance

- Provide KYC documents as prescribed.
- Check the agency number, authorisation and validity of Small Savings / PLI / RPLI agents before transacting with them.
- Keep the passbook updated and secure; obtain a receipt if it is handed to the post office, and check that the last balance matches the receipt.
- Make nominations for all POSB accounts, Savings Certificates, PLI and RPLI.

Financial & General

- Do not disclose the secret code of an instant money order to anyone other than the recipient.
- Collect a receipt when handing over transfer or deceased-claim requests.
- Lodge any service-deficiency complaint within **60 days** of the transaction, and be specific.
- Ensure postal services are not used for money laundering, financing of terrorism, smuggling or any fraudulent/illegal activity.

Part 8 — Grievance Redress Mechanism (Updated)

This section reproduces the charter's Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) and updates the channels and contacts to their August-2026 position.

8.1 When to lodge a complaint

- Within **60 days** of the transaction / availing of a service.
- For claims and customer requests under POSB, Savings Certificates, PLI and RPLI — lodge only after the prescribed service-standard period is over.

8.2 Where and how to lodge

- **Complaint & Suggestion Book** — available in every post office and to be given to the customer on demand.
- **Online** via the India Post **CRM Portal** (crm.indiapost.gov.in), the India Post website (www.indiapost.gov.in) or the Central portal **pgportal.gov.in** (CPGRAMS).
- India Post Call Centre — **1800 266 6868** (toll-free); and on X (Twitter) at **@indiapostoffice**.
- By hand or by post at: the post office where the transaction took place; the office of the Senior Superintendent / Superintendent of Post Offices; or any post office. For Value-Payable articles, lodge at the office of booking.
- PLI / RPLI complaints may be handed or posted to the Deputy Divisional Manager (PLI/RPLI) at each Circle Office headquarters, and the Development Officer (PLI).

CURRENCY ALERT — UPDATED CHANNELS & TIMINGS

New channel: the **India Post CRM Portal** (crm.indiapost.gov.in) now handles complaint registration and tracking — it did not feature in the 2021 charter. **Call-centre timings** are now **agents 8:00 AM – 8:00 PM** with the **IVRS available 24/7, 365 days (except Gazetted Holidays)**; the number 1800 266 6868 is unchanged. “Twitter” is now **X** (x.com/indiapostoffice). The Department's mobile app is now **Dak Sewa 2.0**. (Verified: indiapost.gov.in/contactus, page updated 19 May 2026.)

8.3 Acknowledgement of complaints

- Web complaints — acknowledged instantaneously.
- Complaints handed in person at the Customer Care Centre — acknowledged at the time of handing.
- In all other cases — acknowledgement sent on the day of receipt.

8.4 Time for redress

- **60 days** (if delay is expected, an interim reply within 60 days will give the reason and the extra time needed).

- Complaints requiring investigation — **90 days** (an interim reply may be given).

8.5 Escalation

If the complaint is not redressed in time or to the customer's satisfaction, it may be taken up with the **Postmaster General of the Region** or the **Chief Postmaster General of the Circle**.

8.6 Nodal officers at Headquarters level

Nature of complaint	Nodal officer / address
All complaints other than PLI	Deputy Director General (PG), Department of Posts, Dak Bhavan, New Delhi – 110001. E-mail: ddgpgq@indiapost.gov.in
PLI / RPLI complaints	Directorate of Postal Life Insurance, Chanakyapuri Post Office Complex, 1st Floor, New Delhi – 110021. E-mail: plipg.dte@indiapost.gov.in

CURRENCY ALERT — PLI CONTACT CORRECTED

The 2021 charter gave the PLI nodal contact as *General Manager (Business & Investments)*, ... New Delhi – 110023, gmo.pli@indiapost.gov.in. The current official position is the **Directorate of Postal Life Insurance, Chanakyapuri PO Complex, 1st Floor, New Delhi – 110021**, with complaint e-mail **plipg.dte@indiapost.gov.in**. The PIN in the old charter (110023) was incorrect — Chanakyapuri is **110021**.



Part 9 — Currency & Verification Record

In keeping with Dak Guru's zero-error standard, this part lists exactly what was corrected or updated, and the primary sources checked (August 2026).

9.1 Corrections to the source file

Where	Source file said	Correct / official position
First-Class Mail 1.1	State Cap. → State Cap. = 2–6; Same State = 3–5	Same State = 2–6; State Cap. → State Cap. = 3–5 (values were swapped)
EMS summary 1.4	France 3–6; Japan 4–8	France 4–8; Japan 3–6 (per the official charter and the 106-country annexure)
PLI nodal contact	GM (B&I), New Delhi – 110023; gmo.pli@...	Directorate of PLI, Chanakyapuri, New Delhi – 110021; plipg.dte@...
EMS country spellings	Luxamberg, Netherland, Yaman, Brunei Dar Ussalam	Normalised to Luxembourg, Netherlands, Yemen, Brunei Darussalam (delivery days unchanged)

9.2 Updates layered on top of the 2021 charter

Item	2021 charter	Position verified in August 2026
Governing statute	(Implicitly) Indian Post Office Act, 1898	Post Office Act, 2023 in force 18.06.2024; Post Office Rules, 2024 in force 16.12.2024
Complaint channels	Website, pgportal, call centre, Twitter	Add India Post CRM Portal (crm.indiapost.gov.in); Twitter is now X
Call-centre timings	Number 1800 266 6868	Same number; agents 8 AM–8 PM, IVRS 24/7, 365 days (except Gazetted Holidays)
POSB CBS vs non-CBS	Two parallel blocks 3(a) & 3(b)	CBS now universal in departmental POs; 3(b) is operative, 3(a) is legacy
Mobile app	—	Dak Sewa 2.0
Charter review	Next review due July 2022	No newer charter published as of Aug 2026; June 2021 remains the latest

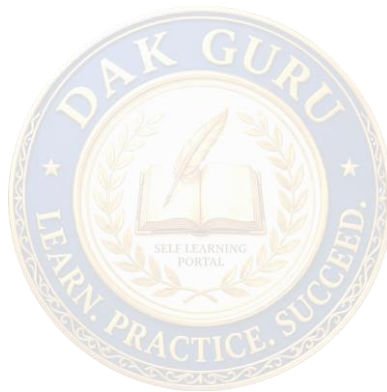
9.3 Confirmed unchanged

- Toll-free number 1800 266 6868; Gazette Notification No. 486 dated 23.09.2013 (still referenced in the current charter); the six postal metros (Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru); OE cities for EMS (Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Kochi); all delivery-day figures in the tables; and the 60-day / 90-day grievance standards.

9.4 Primary sources checked

- Official Citizens' Charter of the Department of Posts, revised June 2021 — www.indiapost.gov.in/documents/CitizenCharter2021.pdf.
- India Post 'Contact Us' page — www.indiapost.gov.in/contactus (page last updated 19 May 2026): call-centre timings, CRM Portal, PLI Directorate address and e-mail.
- Post Office Act, 2023 (Act 43 of 2023) and Post Office Rules, 2024 — India Code / DoP gazette notifications, for the legal-framework note.

Caution: service standards, portals, contact details and monetary/legal provisions change from time to time. Re-verify against the latest orders and the current charter before relying on any point for official or examination purposes.



Part 10 — Rapid Revision & Practice

10.1 Numbers you must remember

Point	Value
Branch Office booking/delivery	+1 day over the standard
Account-office routed transactions (nine schemes)	+6 days over BO standard
Postal metros / MO metros	Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad, Bengaluru (6)
OE cities for International EMS	Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Kochi (5)
Money Order — metro/local	2 working days; Rest of India 4 working days
International Money Transfer (inward)	10 minutes on production of code + documents
Personalized ATM card	30 days
PLI — most services	15 days; death claim 30 (90 if investigation); address change 5
Counter service (excl. queue)	2 – 5 minutes
Complaint acknowledgement / settlement / investigation	Same day / 60 days / 90 days
Complaint to be lodged within	60 days of the transaction

10.2 Practice questions

Q1. The Citizens' Charter of the Department of Posts used as the base here was last revised in —

- (A) March 2016
- (B) June 2021
- (C) July 2022
- (D) January 2024

Q2. An article booked or delivered at a Branch Office takes — over the normal standard.

- (A) No extra time
- (B) 1 extra day
- (C) 2 extra days
- (D) 6 extra days

Q3. Which city is an Office of Exchange (OE) for International EMS but is NOT one of the six postal 'metros'?

- (A) Hyderabad
- (B) Bengaluru
- (C) Kochi
- (D) Chennai

Q4. Delivery standard for a Money Order to 'Rest of India' is —

- (A) 2 working days
- (B) 3 working days
- (C) 4 working days
- (D) 7 working days

- Q5.** Settlement of a PLI/RPLI death claim involving investigation must be completed within —
 (A) 30 days
 (B) 45 days
 (C) 60 days
 (D) 90 days
- Q6.** A personalized ATM card is to be issued within —
 (A) 1 working day
 (B) 7 days
 (C) 15 days
 (D) 30 days
- Q7.** Transactions of the nine schemes routed through the Account Office take — over the BO standard.
 (A) 1 day
 (B) 3 days
 (C) 6 days
 (D) 7 days
- Q8.** A complaint of deficiency in service should be lodged within — of the transaction.
 (A) 30 days
 (B) 45 days
 (C) 60 days
 (D) 90 days
- Q9.** Mail service standards apply to articles conforming to —
 (A) Gazette Notification No. 486 dated 23.09.2013
 (B) the Post Office Act, 2023
 (C) SB Order 9/2021
 (D) the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933
- Q10.** For First-Class Mail, the 'Same State' delivery standard is —
 (A) 2 – 4 days
 (B) 2 – 6 days
 (C) 3 – 5 days
 (D) 5 – 6 days
- Q11.** Which statute now governs the Post Office, replacing the Indian Post Office Act, 1898?
 (A) Post Office Act, 2019
 (B) Post Office Act, 2021
 (C) Post Office Act, 2023
 (D) Post Office Act, 2024
- Q12.** Counter service (excluding waiting time in the queue) is to be completed within —
 (A) 1 – 2 minutes
 (B) 2 – 5 minutes
 (C) 3 minutes
 (D) 10 minutes

Answer key

Q1-B | Q2-B | Q3-C | Q4-C | Q5-D | Q6-D | Q7-C | Q8-C | Q9-A | Q10-B | Q11-C | Q12-B

Annexure I — International EMS Service Standards (all countries)

Note: All international mail is subject to customs examination; that time is not counted. Standards are “end-to-end” for outbound articles booked in the OE cities — **Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai and Kochi**. For articles booked elsewhere, the domestic Speed Post timeline is added. Country names have been normalised to standard spellings; delivery-day figures are exactly as in the charter.

#	Country	Days	#	Country	Days
1	Afghanistan	3 – 7	54	Latvia	5 – 9
2	Argentina	5 – 9	55	Lithuania	5 – 9
3	Australia	4 – 8	56	Luxembourg	4 – 8
4	Austria	4 – 8	57	Macau	4 – 9
5	Bahrain	4 – 8	58	Malawi	6 – 9
6	Bangladesh	3 – 7	59	Malaysia	3 – 7
7	Barbados	5 – 9	60	Maldives	3 – 7
8	Belarus	5 – 9	61	Mauritius	6 – 9
9	Belgium	4 – 8	62	Mexico	5 – 9
10	Bermuda	5 – 9	63	Mongolia	4 – 9
11	Bhutan	3 – 7	64	Morocco	6 – 9
12	Bosnia and Herzegovina	5 – 9	65	Namibia	6 – 9
13	Botswana	6 – 9	66	Nauru	4 – 9
14	Brazil	5 – 9	67	Nepal	3 – 7
15	Brunei Darussalam	3 – 7	68	Netherlands	4 – 8
16	Bulgaria	5 – 9	69	New Zealand	4 – 8
17	Cambodia	3 – 6	70	Niger	6 – 9
18	Canada	5 – 9	71	Nigeria	6 – 9
19	Cape Verde	6 – 9	72	North Macedonia	5 – 9
20	Cayman Islands	5 – 9	73	Norway	4 – 8
21	China	4 – 9	74	Oman	4 – 8
22	Cuba	5 – 9	75	Pakistan	3 – 7
23	Cyprus	5 – 9	76	Panama	5 – 9
24	Dem. Rep. of Congo	6 – 9	77	Papua New Guinea	4 – 9
25	Denmark	4 – 8	78	Philippines	3 – 7
26	Ecuador	5 – 9	79	Poland	5 – 9
27	Egypt	6 – 9	80	Portugal	4 – 8
28	El Salvador	5 – 9	81	Qatar	4 – 8
29	Eritrea	6 – 9	82	Romania	4 – 8
30	Estonia	5 – 9	83	Russia	5 – 9
31	Ethiopia	6 – 9	84	Rwanda	6 – 9

#	Country	Days	#	Country	Days
32	Fiji	4 – 9	85	Saudi Arabia	4 – 8
33	Finland	4 – 8	86	Senegal	6 – 9
34	France	4 – 8	87	Singapore	3 – 6
35	Georgia	2 – 6	88	South Africa	6 – 9
36	Germany	4 – 8	89	South Korea	3 – 7
37	Ghana	6 – 9	90	Spain	4 – 8
38	Greece	5 – 9	91	Sri Lanka	3 – 7
39	Guyana	5 – 9	92	Sudan	6 – 9
40	Hong Kong	3 – 6	93	Sweden	4 – 8
41	Hungary	3 – 7	94	Switzerland	4 – 8
42	Iceland	4 – 8	95	Taiwan	3 – 6
43	Indonesia	3 – 7	96	Tanzania	6 – 9
44	Iran	4 – 9	97	Thailand	3 – 6
45	Iraq	4 – 9	98	Tunisia	6 – 9
46	Ireland	4 – 8	99	Turkey	3 – 6
47	Israel	4 – 9	100	UAE	4 – 8
48	Italy	4 – 8	101	Uganda	6 – 9
49	Japan	3 – 6	102	Ukraine	5 – 9
50	Jordan	4 – 9	103	United Kingdom	2 – 6
51	Kazakhstan	5 – 9	104	USA	4 – 7
52	Kenya	6 – 9	105	Vietnam	3 – 7
53	Kuwait	4 – 8	106	Yemen	4 – 8

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